

# StarHub Studios

WONDERSTORM ACADEMY · CURRICULUM EXPLAINER

# Two things every other school teaches by accident.

*How a child thinks, and how a child reads a room. O.M.G. trains the first. S.O.S. trains the second. Both are built into the Wonderstorm platform today. This document explains what they are, how they work, why they work, and how I designed them.*

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O.M.G.

*Open Minded Goals · Pre-K to 12th · 1,400 cards*

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S.O.S.

*Social Operating Skills · 4 parts · 5 levels · 18 skills*

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WHERE

*Leader, Coach and Parent portals · the academy site*



IF YOU READ ONE PAGE

Academics teach *what* to think. These teach how.

Every tool Wonderstorm rents — reading, maths, science — is about content. Not one of them touches the two things that decide whether a young person can use that content: the quality of their thinking, and their ability to read and respond to the people around them. O.M.G. and S.O.S. are those two things, made teachable, made daily, and made visible.

O.M.G. — Open Minded Goals

S.O.S. — Social Operating Skills

Trains

Shape

Ritual

Evidence

Owned  
by



OPEN MINDED GOALS

A curriculum for the mind that does the learning.

O. M.G. is a cognitive-thinking and rational-behaviour curriculum that runs from Pre-K to 12th grade. It is not a subject and it is not a supplement bolted onto one. It is a parallel spine: a small daily practice that runs alongside everything else the school teaches, and makes everything else the school teaches land better.

It is built as cards, on purpose. Fourteen levels, one per grade band from Pre-K to 12th. Each level has two decks of fifty: a **Cognitive Thinking** deck and a **Rational Thinking** deck. One thousand four hundred cards in total, every one written for its age, every one a single thing a young person can do or think through in a few minutes.

| Deck               | What it trains | What a card looks like |
|--------------------|----------------|------------------------|
| Cognitive Thinking |                |                        |
| Rational Thinking  |                |                        |

The name is the method. **Open Minded Goals**: a goal is set, the mind is opened to more than its first reaction, and the leader chooses. The word “Open” is doing the work — it is the opposite of the rigid, automatic thinking that cognitive science has identified as the root of most poor decisions at every age.

THE DAILY HAND

Five cards. Two minutes. Every day.

In the Leader portal, O.M.G. is a programme next to reading, maths, science and puzzles. The leader is placed at their level automatically from their grade — a Coach can move them — and chooses a deck. Then they draw.

| Step                                  | What happens | Why it is built this way |
|---------------------------------------|--------------|--------------------------|
| 1 · Draw a hand                       |              |                          |
| 2 · Cognitive cards — do it           |              |                          |
| 3 · Rational cards — think it through |              |                          |
| 4 · Hand summary                      |              |                          |
| 5 · It lands                          |              |                          |

THE APPROACH — IN JACK'S WORDS

I did not start with children. I started with the thinking.

O.M.G. grew out of cognitive-thinking work I have been building since 2019: an adult programme, run one-to-one with a life coach, built on a single premise — that most of what goes wrong in a life goes wrong in the thinking first, and that thinking can be trained like anything else. The standards of that programme are still the standards of O.M.G.: openness, honesty, trust, support, and looking honestly at your own role in your own problems instead of blaming them on other people or things.

The science underneath it is not mine and I do not pretend it is. It is the cognitive-behavioural tradition: Aaron Beck's work on cognitive distortions — the automatic, rigid patterns like “should” statements that turn ordinary situations into frustration and resentment — and Albert Ellis's rational-emotive work on replacing rigid demands with flexible preferences. The move is always the same: notice the thought, test it, choose a better one, then act. What I did was ask a question I had not seen answered: what would this look like if you started at four years old instead of forty?

| Design principle | What it means in practice |
|------------------|---------------------------|
|------------------|---------------------------|

Two decks, not one

Fourteen levels, one per year

Cards, not chapters

No “bad” feelings, no wrong answers

Agency is the goal

Six focus areas throughout

Jack — this section is your story, told back to you from your own documents. Read it before it goes to David and change anything that is not how you would say it.

THE BENEFITS

The spine nothing else in the building has.

For What changes

*The leader*

*The Coach*

*The parent*

*The school*

*The academics*

S O C I A L   O P E R A T I N G   S K I L L S

# Most children are taught “be yourself.” S.O.S. teaches them to read the room.

**S.** *O.S. is a complete operating system for how a young person moves through other people. Not a worksheet, not a unit: a thesis, four teachable parts, a five-level scale, eighteen named skills, and the activities that practise them. Its core instrument is **Social Calibration**.*

*The thesis is the reason it exists. “Be yourself” is the standard advice and it is useless in the moment a child is misreading a room, because it tells them the problem is who they are rather than what they are noticing. S.O.S. replaces identity advice with a skill: adjust the delivery, never the person. A child who cannot read a room is sending one.*

| The four parts                               | The question the leader learns to ask |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 01 · <i>Reading the Room</i>                 |                                       |
| 02 · <i>Reading Yourself</i>                 |                                       |
| 03 · <i>Choosing an Intentional Response</i> |                                       |
| 04 · <i>Staying Authentic</i>                |                                       |



THE FIVE LEVELS AND THE EIGHTEEN SKILLS

A child is never “bad at people.” They are at a 2 today, and they can name what a 3 looks like.

| Level                  | What the leader says about themselves |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| 1 · <i>Unaware</i>     |                                       |
| 2 · <i>Noticing</i>    |                                       |
| 3 · <i>Adjusting</i>   |                                       |
| 4 · <i>Intentional</i> |                                       |
| 5 · <i>Leadership</i>  |                                       |

Leaders evaluate themselves after activities against this scale. That single design choice shifts the whole conversation from judgement to growth: there is always a next rung, and the child can say it in their own words. Eighteen skills are practised by name: active listening · eye contact · voice volume · reading facial expressions · personal space · body language · asking questions · timing · humour · conflict resolution · giving feedback · receiving feedback · welcoming new people · including others · navigating disagreements · public speaking · group conversations · one-on-one conversations.

*I Master Me*

*The 3 B's*

*The 10/10 Rule*

*The Check-In*

*360° Feedback*

THE APPROACH — IN JACK'S WORDS

# The volume, not the music.

**S.** *O.S. came from watching what actually separates the young people who thrive from the ones who struggle, and noticing it was almost never intelligence. It was calibration: whether they could feel the room and adjust without losing themselves. Nobody was teaching it, because everyone assumed it could not be taught. So I broke it into parts that can.*

| Design principle                                   | What it means in practice |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <i>Skill, not identity</i>                         |                           |
| <i>A scale, not a verdict</i>                      |                           |
| <i>Eighteen names</i>                              |                           |
| <i>Regulation first</i>                            |                           |
| <i>The group's read enters the record</i>          |                           |
| <i>Authenticity is a part, not an afterthought</i> |                           |

*Jack — same as section 03: this is your reasoning in your voice, reconstructed from what you have said and built. Correct anything before it reaches David.*

THE BENEFITS

The one thing parents cannot get anywhere else.

For What changes

The leader

The Coach

The parent

The school

O.M.G. is the thinking inside a leader.  
S.O.S. is the thinking between leaders.

**T**hey are built to be used together. A Rational Thinking card in O.M.G. asks a leader to choose a more open-minded thought about a situation; S.O.S. is what they use when that situation has other people in it. I Master Me regulates the state; O.M.G. trains the thought; Social Calibration shapes the response. The instruments are shared, the evidence flows into one place, and the Coach sees one child, not three programmes.

THE CLOSE — NOTHING TO REINVENT, NOTHING TO RETRAIN

# It drops into the day you already run.

Neither curriculum asks Wonderstorm to change how it teaches. They slot into the rhythm the school already has — Morning Circle, Core Academics, Expedition Time, Closing Circle — and into the portal the leaders already open. Here is what integration actually means, for the student and for the teacher, starting the day you say go.

| For the student | For the teacher |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| O.M.G.          |                 |
| S.O.S.          |                 |
| Lesson planning |                 |
| Training        |                 |
| Day one         |                 |
|                 |                 |

THE CLOSE

Not whether. When, and where in the week.

| Decision | What it means |
|----------|---------------|
|----------|---------------|

*The O.M.G. slot*

*Side by side*

*The four academic  
programmes*

*Everything in this document exists today, on the preview, at the passcode you already have. Nothing here is a plan. It is built, and it is waiting for a start date.*